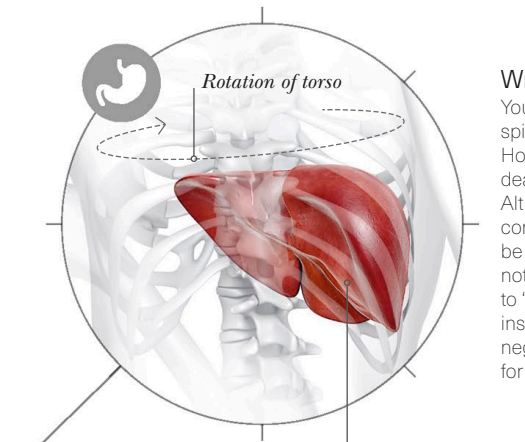




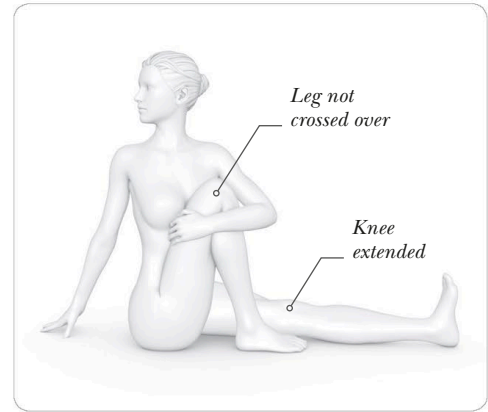
Rotation of torso

Wringing out toxins

You may have heard that spinal twists “wring out toxins.” However, your liver efficiently deals with toxins automatically. Although mechanically compressing the organs may be beneficial, evidence does not show that this contributes to “detoxification.” You can instead visualize wringing out negative energy as you twist, for psychological benefit.

Your liver naturally detoxifies

Deep to the erector spinae, the multifidus is dynamically engaging

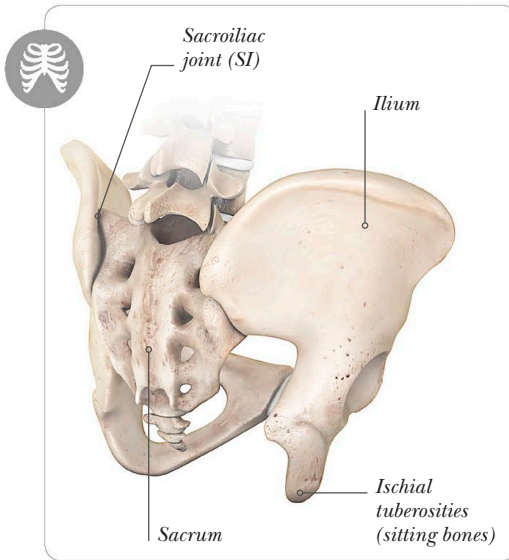


Leg not crossed over

Knee extended

VARIATION

For a gentler twist, keep one leg extended and consider not crossing the lifted leg over the midline. Use your arm wrapped around the leg to help you sit tall as you twist.



Sacroiliac joint (SI)

Ilium

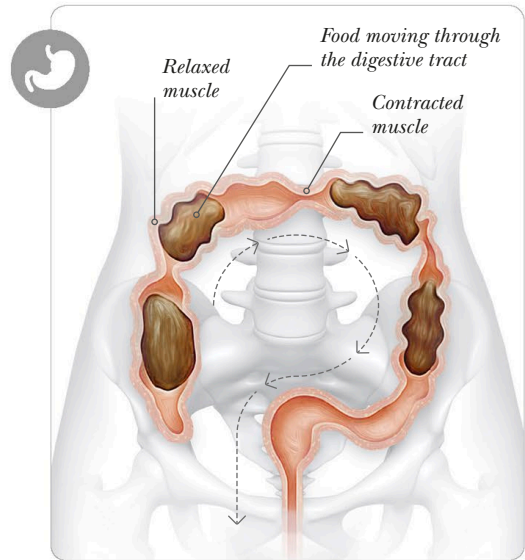
Sacrum

Ischial tuberosities (sitting bones)

Sacroiliac joint

Allow your sitting bones to move slightly on the floor with the twist. If you anchor them down, the twist puts a lot of pressure on the structure of the SI joint, which can cause aches. Alternatively, allowing too much movement in your SI joint can also lead to achiness.

Find the middle way for your body.



Relaxed muscle

Food moving through the digestive tract

Contracted muscle

Stimulating peristalsis

In your digestive tract, peristalsis is the involuntary engagement of smooth muscles to move digesting food (see p.39). Thankfully, you don't have to consciously tell your stomach to empty into the small intestines. Stress and a sedentary lifestyle can affect peristalsis and lead to digestive issues. Twisting can stimulate healthy peristalsis.

POSTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW